

Introduction

In a world of personal computers dominated by bulky and unstable operating systems, Macintosh has popularly been viewed with admiration and awe for its intuitiveness, style and usability. The first set of personal computers to be commercially successful, the first popular graphic user interface, the first laptops in the market; the list of achievements by the Macintosh line of products is endless.

With its focus on aesthetics and high price tag, for a long time the Macintosh was limited to a small customer base consisting of Apple enthusiasts. But with the entry of the Apple Inc in the consumer electronics market and its transition to Intel processors, the platform is beginning to gain popularity.

Powered by the philosophy of comprehensive aesthetic considerations and ease of use, the success of the Macintosh has spawned a series of derivative products that have revolutionised their respective segments. The Apple iPhone is doing to mobile phones what Macintoshes did to computers, adding a feeling of sophistication and suaveness while far outclassing all competition in terms of quality. The newly announce iPad promises to do the same with netbooks.

At the core of these success stories is the story of the Mac OS, the powerbase behind the Macintosh. Universally preferred by graphic designers, artists and other creative users, this award winning OS keeps the functionality of the computer as its core idea, protecting the user from getting caught up in a myriad of technical details. A true reflection of the Apple philosophy, this OS has matured with the company, growing from a little GUI OS in the early 1980s to the Mac OS X Snow Leopard in 2009, a truly powerful OS capable of holding its own against any other OS, may it be Windows or Linux.

And so it is that we bring you this fast track, aimed at enabling you and making you aware of the world of the Macintosh. All chapters have been written with the assumption that you are new